

YOUR GAME · SUN, SEP 6 · 1930 ET · NBC

Wisconsin (8%) at #4 Notre Dame (92%) Notre Dame -20.5

Win and Notre Dame's playoff odds are 76.7%; lose and they're 63.2%. A 13.5-point swing, the biggest thing on this page by far.

Ranked by leverage · how much the result moves Notre Dame's playoff odds, discounted by how unlikely the swing is · the boxed team is the one to pull for

- 1

Mon, Sep 7 · 1930 ET · ESPN

#19 SMU (52%)

 at **Florida State** (48%) SMU -3 · O/U 53.5

A SMU win happens 52% of the time and is worth 0.22 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.6%)
Mostly because SMU is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 12); the better their record, the more your result against them counts (proj. 8 wins); also Florida State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.

Leverage 48 Impact 38
- 2

Fri, Sep 4 · 2100 ET · FOX

Fresno State (10%)

 at **#14 USC** (90%) USC -22.5 · O/U 51.5

A Fresno St win happens 10% of the time and is worth 0.32 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because USC is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 14% of seasons).

Leverage 25 Impact 56
- 3

Sun, Sep 6 · 1930 ET · ABC

#24 Louisville (37%)

 at **#9 Ole Miss** (63%) Ole Miss -6.5 · O/U 55.5

A Louisville win happens 37% of the time and is worth 0.12 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.7%)
Because Ole Miss is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 10% of seasons).

Leverage 24 Impact 21
- 4

Sun, Sep 6 · 1600 ET · NBC

Washington State (9%)

 at **#17 Washington** (91%) Washington -23.5 · O/U 51.5

A Wash St win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.31 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Washington is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 22 Impact 54
- 5

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · FOX

Boston College (32%)

 at **Cincinnati** (68%) Cincinnati -7.5 · O/U 49.5

A Boston Col win happens 32% of the time and is worth 0.11 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.8% vs 74.6%)
Mostly because Boston College is on Notre Dame's schedule (wk 11); the better their record, the more your result against them counts; also Cincinnati is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you.

Leverage 22 Impact 20
- 6

Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · ABC

Clemson (28%)

 at **#11 LSU** (72%) LSU -10 · O/U 50.5

A Clemson win happens 28% of the time and is worth 0.12 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.8%)
Because LSU is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 21 Impact 21
- 7

Sat, Sep 5 · 1200 ET · ABC

East Carolina (9%)

 at **#13 Alabama** (91%) Alabama -28.5 · O/U 52.5

A ECU win happens 9% of the time and is worth 0.25 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 74.9% vs 74.7%)
Because Alabama is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 18 Impact 44
- 8

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · FS1

Marshall (5%)

 at **#18 Penn State** (95%) Penn State -23.5 · O/U 52.5

A Marshall win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.34 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Penn State is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 15 Impact 61
- 9

Sat, Sep 5 · 1930 ET · NBC

Western Michigan (6%)

 at **#16 Michigan** (94%) Michigan -27.5 · O/U 49.5

A W Michigan win happens 6% of the time and is worth 0.27 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Michigan is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 12% of seasons).

Leverage 14 Impact 48
- 10

Sat, Sep 5 · 1530 ET · ESPN

Texas State (5%)

 at **#5 Texas** (95%) Texas -29.5 · O/U 59.5

A Texas St win happens 5% of the time and is worth 0.33 pts of playoff odds (Notre Dame 75.0% vs 74.7%)
Because Texas is competing with Notre Dame for an at-large spot; a loss makes them likelier to finish behind you (they block you in 16% of seasons).

Leverage 14 Impact 59

Leverage and impact are scaled 0–100 against the biggest remaining game that doesn't involve Notre Dame. Win chances from SP+ with home advantage; every number from 30,000 simulated seasons with each game flipped one at a time.